



# Ingenious orchids

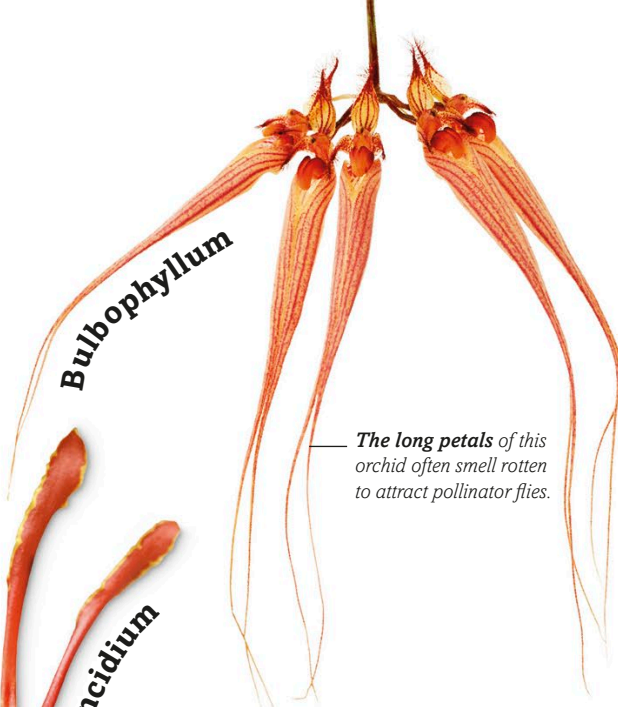
**Moth orchid**



*These decorative petals can be red, white, yellow, or pink.*

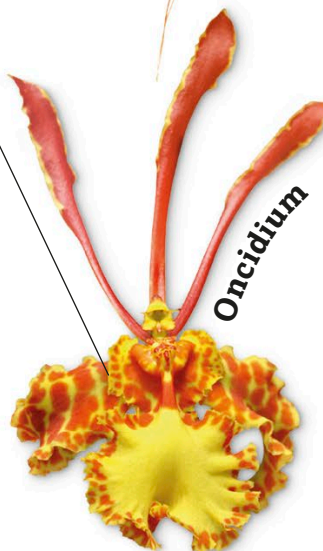
*Large, long-lived flowers make this orchid a popular houseplant.*

**Bulbophyllum**



*The long petals of this orchid often smell rotten to attract pollinator flies.*

**Oncidium**



*These unusual speckled flowers bloom for two to three months in a year.*

**Zygopetalum**



*Large petal acts as a landing platform for insects.*

*Cross-shaped lip petals give this orchid its name.*

**Red cross orchid**



*One colorful petal is the focus of these unusual flowers.*

**Epicattleya  
Rene Marques**



Orchids are beautiful flowers with clever tactics for attracting pollinators. Some mimic male insects, so rival males will attack them and get covered in pollen. Others attract male insects by looking like females. Some flowers entice bees and butterflies with a sweet smell, while others stink of rotting meat to draw flies.

Orchids are found almost everywhere in the world but are most common in the tropics where, like the **vanda** orchid, they live high in the rain forest trees. In cooler climates orchids usually grow on the ground. All orchids have three outer sepals and three inner petals, including a distinctive lip petal that acts as a landing